

MOTION OS

Compose Motion & Pixels

Choosing the right API · live demos in the app



This deck is one `updateTransition`. Every flourish names its API.

GOAL

Leave knowing which API

- 1 Which API for which problem — not a catalog dump
- 2 When Canvas / custom Layout is actually worth it
- 3 Shared performance rules we can ship with

AGENDA

Five beats, then Q&A

- 1 Animation decision tree + live proof
- 2 Graphics & Layout tree + live proof
- 3 Performance checklist
- 4 Apply to our apps
- 5 Q&A

When not to animate

- Prefer system / Material defaults first
- Motion must serve hierarchy or feedback
- If it fights readability or a11y — cut it
- Games and Canvas are rare in product UI

Custom is for moments that sell the product.

Need motion?

Tap a branch we will prove

- └─ Appear / disappear? → `AnimatedVisibility`
- └─ Swap content / screens? → `AnimatedContent`
- └─ Many props, one state? → `updateTransition`
- └─ Imperative / interruptible? → `Animatable`
- └─ Gesture / organic settle? → `spring()`
- └─ Authored “story” timing? → `keyframes`
- └─ List ↔ detail continuity? → `SharedTransition`
- └─ Per-frame draw / game? → `withFrameNanos + Canvas`

Live app: tappable branches jump to proof. PDF: pattern only.

Intent, not decoration

tween

Directed, timed · enter / morph

spring

Physical · drag release, playful

keyframes

Hand-authored · overshoot, pauses

infinite

Loop · loaders (sparingly)

Animation APIs — what they do

APPEAR & SWAP

AnimatedVisibility	Show or hide with Enter / Exit
AnimatedContent	Swap screens or content (A → B)
Crossfade	Fade-only content swap
animateContentSize	Animate size when children change

DRIVE VALUES

animate*AsState	One property toward one target
updateTransition	Many properties, one discrete state
Animateable	Imperative: snap, stop, sequence, cancel
rememberInfiniteTransition	Looping values — loaders, ambient
animateDecay	Fling from remaining velocity

SPECS · INTENT

tween	Directed, timed — enter, morph, structure
spring	Physics settle — drag release, playful tap
keyframes	Authored story — race, pause, overshoot
snap	Jump with no interpolation
repeatable	Play N times, or forever

CONTINUITY

SharedTransitionLayout	Scope wrapping both destinations
sharedElement	The same visual object travels
sharedBounds	Bounds morph; content inside can differ

PER-FRAME

withFrameNanos	Vsync clock — simulation, games, orbits
-----------------------	---

Not every function in `androidx.compose.animation` — the set we choose from. Tree picks; table names.

PROOF

Morphing Action Button

- One state. Width, color, glyph stay in lockstep.
- Tween the structure. Spring the glyph.
- Pay / save / sync in our apps.

updateTransition

animateDp

PathMeasure

graphicsLayer

```
updateTransition(state)
animateDp { Idle → 280.dp; Loading → 66.dp }
textAlpha delayMillis = 120 // structure leads
```

LIVE IN MOTION OS

Idle → Loading → Done

Not interactive in PDF. Run the app on a tablet (shortest side ≥ 600 dp) and open Morphing Action Button.

showcase/components/MorphingActionButton.kt

PSEUDOCODE

updateTransition — morphing button

one state → many properties

updateTransition(buttonState)

```
width    ← tween      Idle / Loading / Done
color    ← tween
label    ← tween + 120ms delay  // structure leads
glyph    ← spring      // micro-interaction
```

Full source in Android Studio

app/.../showcase/components/MorphingActionButton.kt

PROOF

Keyframes Theme Wipe

- Tap to wipe light ↔ dark.

Animatable

keyframes

clipRect

```
keyframes {  
  0.90f at 520 using cinematic  
  overshoot at 700  
  target at 850  
}
```

LIVE IN MOTION OS

Race · overshoot · settle

Animation drives clipRect — a drawing primitive, not a layout property. Open Keyframes Theme Wipe in the app.

showcase/KeyframesThemeWipeDemo.kt

PSEUDOCODE

keyframes + clipRect wipe

Animatable fraction 0 → 1

keyframes:

 race to 90% @ 520ms

 overshoot @ 700ms

 settle @ 850ms

clipRect(width × fraction) // draw, not layout

Full source in Android Studio

app/.../showcase/KeyframesThemeWipeDemo.kt

PROOF

Shared Element Gallery

- The card travels — it doesn't swap.
- Keys: swatch-id, title-id.
- Compose's answer to hero transitions.

SharedTransitionLayout

sharedElement

AnimatedContent

```
SharedTransitionLayout {  
    Modifier.sharedElement(  
        rememberSharedContentState("swatch-$id")  
    )  
}
```

LIVE IN MOTION OS

The card travels

Stable unique keys. Don't share huge subtrees. Test back stack in real nav — open Shared Element Gallery in the app.

showcase/SharedElementGalleryDemo.kt

Draw or place?

Custom drawing or layout?

- └ Tint / shape / clip only?
- └ Charts, gauges, game art?
- └ Children in custom positions?
- └ Deferred / dependent measure?

→ Modifier / Shape

→ Canvas + DrawScope

→ custom Layout

→ SubcomposeLayout

Canvas is not a layout system. Layout is not a drawing API.

Canvas Pulse Chart

- Designer gives you a custom chart? This is where you land.
- One fraction. Many properties.
- Same cinematic pattern as UI morphs.

Canvas

Path

Animatable

stagger

```
val t = remember { Animatable(0f) }
```

```
Canvas { drawPath(area, brush) }
```

```
localT = ((t - i * 0.06f) / 0.7f)
```

LIVE IN MOTION OS

Grid · area · bars

All DrawScope. One Animatable(0→1); bars stagger locally.
Open Canvas Pulse Chart in the app.

`showcase/CanvasPulseChartDemo.kt`

LAYOUT

Fan Deck

- Layout places. Canvas draws the ring.
- `zIndex` = frontness. `graphicsLayer` sells depth.
- Swipe / tap — spring settle. Product: wallet, stories, picker.

Layout

`placeRelative`

`zIndex`

`graphicsLayer`

`spring`

```
val a = PI/2 + 2π * (i - selected) / n
p.placeRelative(x, y, zIndex = frontness)
// graphicsLayer { rotationY = ...; scale = depth }
```

LIVE IN MOTION OS

Measure, then place

No Row/Column trigonometry hacks. Open Fan Deck in the app and swipe.

`showcase/OrbitalMenuLayoutDemo.kt`

PSEUDOCODE

custom Layout — fan deck

Layout:

measure each child

place on ellipse(selected)

zIndex = frontness // who is in front

graphicsLayer: rotationY, scale // depth, not placement

Canvas: draw the ring

spring settle after swipe

[Full source in Android Studio](#)

app/.../showcase/OrbitalMenuLayoutDemo.kt

INTENSITY

Same toolbox. Different intensity.

A · CINEMATIC UI

Aurora Unlock

Hold the core. Animatable, springs, shared clock.

B · GAME LOOP

Neon Rush

withFrameNanos racer. Same Canvas primitives. Not default product UI.

Performance checklist

- 1 `graphicsLayer / draw / offset { }` — not layout every frame
- 2 Cache Path / paints in hot 60fps loops
- 3 One shared clock for coordinated effects
- 4 Don't animate a state read in every parent
- 5 Shared elements: stable keys, small regions
- 6 Shaders / AGSL: API guards + fallbacks

OUR APPS

Fill this with the room

MOMENT

Primary CTA async

List → detail

Theme / onboarding flourish

Analytics widget

Radial / fan picker

Everything else

API

Morphing button / `updateTransition`

Shared elements

`keyframes` (sparingly)

Canvas chart

custom Layout (if design requires)

Material + Visibility / Content

Canvas / Layout only when Material + standard animation can't express the design.

The lab is this repo

- 1 Compose Lab → [app/.../showcase/](#)
- 2 Handout → [docs/compose-lab-handout.md](#)
- 3 This PDF deck → [docs/talk/index.html](#)
- 4 github.com/abdul-wahab-9d/MotionOS

No tablet? Phone layout is a tap-through lab.

Your motion bugs, please

Where have we fought motion jank?

Any design ask that forced Canvas prematurely?

Who wants a follow-up on Nav + shared elements?

LAYOUT

Measure children, then `placeRelative` — that's custom layout from scratch. Canvas is for pixels, not for placing children.

ANIMATION

Visibility you know. Custom means `Animatable` + a spec. Story timing is keyframes. Physics is spring. Continuity across screens is shared elements.

THANK YOU

TEAM LEAD

Hammad Nawaz

and the team

Animatable

spring

keyframes

sharedElement

Canvas

Layout

Motion OS — tablet = deck

- 1 Clone the repo and run the app in Android Studio
- 2 Tablet or Pixel Tablet AVD (shortest side ≥ 600 dp) opens this talk
- 3 Phone opens Compose Lab — the demo list
- 4 Clicker: volume / D-pad / space · notes: N

Demos in this PDF are stills. The motion lives in the app.